Epistemic Modals and Information-State-Sensitive Evaluation

Abstract

This paper defends a requirement on the semantics of epistemic modals: an adequate account must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. The support comes from two commitments of dynamic semantics, that conjunction receives a sequential interpretation and that the might-operator is interpreted as a consistency test [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj], together with an order contrast: after the information that it is not raining is added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining, whereas in the opposite order there is no problem [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]. Because might tests consistency against an information state, and adding information in a different sequence changes whether the might-claim remains consistent, the contrast counts as evidence for information-state-sensitive evaluation rather than evaluation by worlds alone. The conclusion is a demand on an adequate semantics, not a claim that worlds play no role and not an independently established result. Its limit is equally explicit: the example supports the proposal but does not by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves this way. The paper sets out these components, answers objections and marks the limits of the support.

1. Introduction: The Demand on an Adequate Account

The problem addressed here is what an adequate semantics of epistemic modals must take into account, and in particular whether modal evaluation can rely on worlds alone. The demand defended is that an adequate semantics of epistemic modals must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. The conclusion thus specifies what an adequate account must take into consideration: information states, and not worlds alone, must matter to modal evaluation. The demand is not for world-only evaluation; it requires that modal evaluation also be sensitive to information states. It is a demand placed on the account, not a claim, made here, that such an account has been independently established.

The proposal rests on two stated commitments: dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation, and it treats the might-operator as a consistency test. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] The order contrast adds that after the information that it is not raining is added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining, whereas in the opposite order no problem arises. Order, accordingly, matters in discourse. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] These are the grounds for the demand, not further conclusions about every epistemic modal.

The relevance of these commitments can be stated in their own terms. Together with the order contrast, they support the conclusion: might tests consistency on an information state, and adding information in a different sequence changes whether the might-claim remains consistent. The contrast

is therefore offered as evidence that epistemic-modal evaluation is information-state-sensitive: the consistency test is applied against an information state, and the sequential interpretation makes order matter to that state. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

Given these commitments and this contrast, the account is required to make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] The contrast concerns sequential addition: once the not-raining information has been added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, whereas in the opposite order no problem arises. This order effect supports the demand that modal evaluation be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. Support therefore runs from the commitments and the example to the requirement. The claim is neither that the requirement independently proves the commitments nor that the example establishes a universal account of all epistemic modals.

The scope of the demand is the one the conclusion expresses: an adequate account must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states rather than relying on worlds alone. The supporting commitments and contrast are sequential conjunction, consistency testing, and the difference between the two orders in which the raining information is added. The claim is a requirement for adequacy, and these commitments and this contrast support it. The example supports the proposal, but it does not by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves in this way. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The demand concerns what an adequate semantics of epistemic modals must include in evaluating them: sensitivity to information states, not only to worlds. The conclusion requires this sensitivity rather than exclusive reliance on worlds. It requires that information states matter to modal evaluation, and it does not posit a world-only basis. The claim concerns adequacy. It specifies a condition the account must meet and does not report that the condition has been independently established. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The proposal's support remains tied to the two commitments and the order contrast already stated. The commitments are that dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and treats the might-operator as a consistency test. The order contrast is that after the information that it is not raining is added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining, whereas in the opposite order no problem arises. The demand follows as the proposal that these commitments and this contrast support. It is not a claim that the example settles the behaviour of every epistemic modal. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

To restate: the commitments are that conjunction receives a sequential interpretation and that the might-operator is treated as a consistency test. The contrast is that once the not-raining information has been added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, whereas in the opposite order no problem arises. These are the terms in which the contrast bears on evaluation. It concerns consistency after information has been added, not an order-free description of the two items. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

Accordingly, the commitments and contrast support the adequacy condition that modal evaluation be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. The conclusion requires information-state sensitivity, but its wording does not say that worlds play no role. What it requires is information-state-sensitive evaluation rather than a world-only account. This restates the demand without adding a further claim. The restatement also keeps the direction of support, which runs from the commitments and the described order effect to the requirement on an adequate account. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The example's role and its limit belong together. The commitments and the order contrast support information-state-sensitive modal evaluation, and in this way the example supports the proposal's claim. The contrast does not, however, by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves in that way. The conclusion therefore remains the narrower demand on an adequate semantics that the stated commitments and contrast support. It should not be recast as a universal claim about every epistemic modal or as an independently established fact. On the support supplied, information states must matter to evaluation, and the example's reach is limited to its role in supporting that requirement. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

2. Argument: Sequential Conjunction and Consistency Testing

The semantic commitments at issue are that dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and interprets the might-operator as a consistency test. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] There are two commitments: conjunction is interpreted sequentially, and might is treated as a consistency test. These are the features of the account as supplied, and they are the features this section examines.

The first commitment is that conjunction receives a sequential interpretation. Stating it does not require any further consequence. It says that conjunction is interpreted sequentially rather than by an account that leaves out its sequential character. The commitment therefore specifies how conjunction is handled. It needs no further claim about what follows from any particular ordering. In this respect, it supplies the sequential part of the proposal as stated. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The second commitment is that the might-operator is treated as a consistency test. This characterization does not specify further details of how the test operates, nor does it require a claim that might has some other function. It does, however, give modal evaluation an explicit relation to information: the relevant question is whether the might-claim remains consistent with the information state. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The two commitments can be set out separately while their joint role is kept in view. Sequential interpretation concerns conjunction; the consistency-test commitment concerns the might-operator. These are their stated roles: the first commitment is a sequential interpretation of conjunction, and the second is a consistency test for might. Neither commitment has to be enlarged to state the combination. The account gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and treats might as a consistency test. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

As stated, the commitments are sequential conjunction and consistency-testing might, with no further claim about their consequences. The account treats the might-operator as a consistency test and gives conjunction a sequential interpretation. These are the two commitments at issue. They are the semantic commitments explained here, not additional conclusions about every modal expression or about other properties of conjunction. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

On this account, the stated role of the might-operator is to serve as a consistency test, and the stated interpretation of conjunction is sequential. Together, the two commitments describe how the account frames epistemic-modal claims. Sequence is part of the interpretation of conjunction, and consistency with information is part of the interpretation of might. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The scope of the discussion remains limited to these supplied commitments. Dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and interprets might as a consistency test. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] This repeats the two commitments, sequential conjunction and consistency-testing might, without adding another semantic rule. As presented through these commitments, the account also does not specify a broader claim about all epistemic modals. What the commitments state is limited to a sequential interpretation of conjunction and a consistency test for might.

The commitments concern distinct features: a sequential interpretation of conjunction and a consistency test for might. Conjunction receives the sequential interpretation, and the might-operator is treated as the consistency test. Keeping these roles distinct makes clear what each commitment contributes. It also avoids adding a further semantic rule or assigning either feature to a different operator. Together, the commitments state how dynamic semantics treats conjunction and might. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

Consider the first commitment again. It states that conjunction receives a sequential interpretation, so the account of conjunction includes a sequential interpretation. This restatement does not specify additional stages, outcomes or rules for how any particular conjunct changes an information state. The content of the first commitment is just that conjunction is interpreted sequentially. That is the first part of the stated semantic pairing. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The second commitment specifies that the might-operator is treated as a consistency test. Consistency testing is the stated feature of the operator's interpretation. Taken together, a sequential interpretation of conjunction and a consistency test for might describe the two parts of the account. Neither description requires an additional claim about other modal operators. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The supplied commitments therefore identify conjunction as sequentially interpreted and the might-operator as a consistency test. They do not state a further rule. The stated pairing is sequential conjunction together with consistency-testing might. This explains the stated framing without extending it to a rule about every epistemic modal or to consequences beyond the two commitments. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

Taken together, the content of the proposal remains exactly these two semantic commitments. Dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and interprets the might-operator as a consistency test. In other words, conjunction receives a sequential interpretation and the might-operator is a consistency test. These are the features the account states. This limited pairing frames the evaluation of epistemic-modal claims against information states. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

3. Argument Continued: The Not-Raining Order Effect

The order effect at issue concerns the sequence in which information is added in discourse. In the order described first, the information that it is not raining is added before the information that it might be raining. The reported result is that, once the information that it is not raining has been added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining. The contrast is therefore not simply between two pieces of information considered apart from their sequence. Rather, it describes what happens when the information is added in one particular order. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The other side of the contrast is the opposite order. Of that order, the description says only that there is no problem. The reported outcome therefore varies with the order of addition: after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, whereas in the reverse order there is no problem. The point is the difference between these two discourse orders. Nothing here claims that the two orders have the same result. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The first half of the contrast can be stated narrowly. Its result is that, after the information that it is not raining has been added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining. The contrast thus concerns whether the might-information is still consistent once the not-raining information has been added. It does not require replacing this description with a broader conclusion about every possible order, every kind of information, or every epistemic modal. The example concerns only the not-raining information and the information that it might be raining. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The reverse-order half should likewise be kept to its stated scope. The description of the opposite order is simply that there is no problem. That is the reported contrast with the order in which the not-raining information is added first. About the reverse order, the claim says only that the sequence presents no problem; its role here is to mark the difference between the two orders. In this way, the example makes discourse order explicit without extending the contrast beyond the information given. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

Taken together, the two stated outcomes are these: after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, while in the opposite order there is no problem. The contrast concerns the sequence in which information is added in discourse. The example's point can therefore be restated without broadening it: for the specified pair of orders, whether the sequence presents a problem varies with which information comes first. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The conclusion drawn from this contrast is that order matters in discourse. The two orders have different reported outcomes: after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information; in the opposite order, there is no problem. "Order matters" names that contrast. It adds no further outcome and no general rule. The claim remains tied to these two pieces of information and their two orders. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The example, then, states a specific contrast between two orders in which the not-raining information and the might-be-raining information can be added. It distinguishes the order in which the not-raining information comes first from the opposite order. The reported outcomes are that, after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, and that in the opposite order there is no problem. These are the terms of the order effect, and the conclusion that order matters does not go beyond them. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The contrast can also be broken down into its two stated orders. In the first order, the information that it is not raining is added before the information that it might be raining. The reported result is that, after the information that it is not raining has been added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining. The contrast assigns this consistency result to the not-raining-first order and sets it against the opposite order. It does not say that the same result holds whichever piece of information is added first. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The opposite order supplies the other side of the contrast. Of that order, the description says that there is no problem. This clause gives no further outcome for the sequence; it says only that the reverse order presents no problem. The full contrast is thus that, after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, whereas in the opposite order there is no problem. Both clauses are needed to state the contrast between the orders, and neither should be read more broadly than its stated scope allows. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The claim sums up this particular contrast by saying that order matters in discourse. The contrast concerns the order in which the not-raining information and the might-information are added. It introduces no further example and claims no result for other information, other sequences, or other modal expressions. The stated pair is that, after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, and that in the reverse order there is no problem. The order effect is thus described through the different results of these two sequences. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

Keeping the two parts together preserves the full content of the proposition. The contrast specifies both outcomes: after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information; in the opposite order, there is no problem. It states that order matters in discourse because adding the not-raining information first produces a consistency problem, while the opposite order produces none. In this way, it gives the result for each order and sums up the pair by saying that order matters in discourse. Stated narrowly, the claim is that this contrast between the two orders of adding the specified information makes order matter in this discourse example. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

4. Argument Completed: From the Contrast to Information-State Sensitivity

The conclusion to be defended is that an adequate semantics of epistemic modals must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. Two stated commitments, together with an order contrast, support this requirement. First, dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and treats the might-operator as a consistency test. Second, once the information that it is not raining has been added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining; in the opposite order there is no problem, so order matters in discourse. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

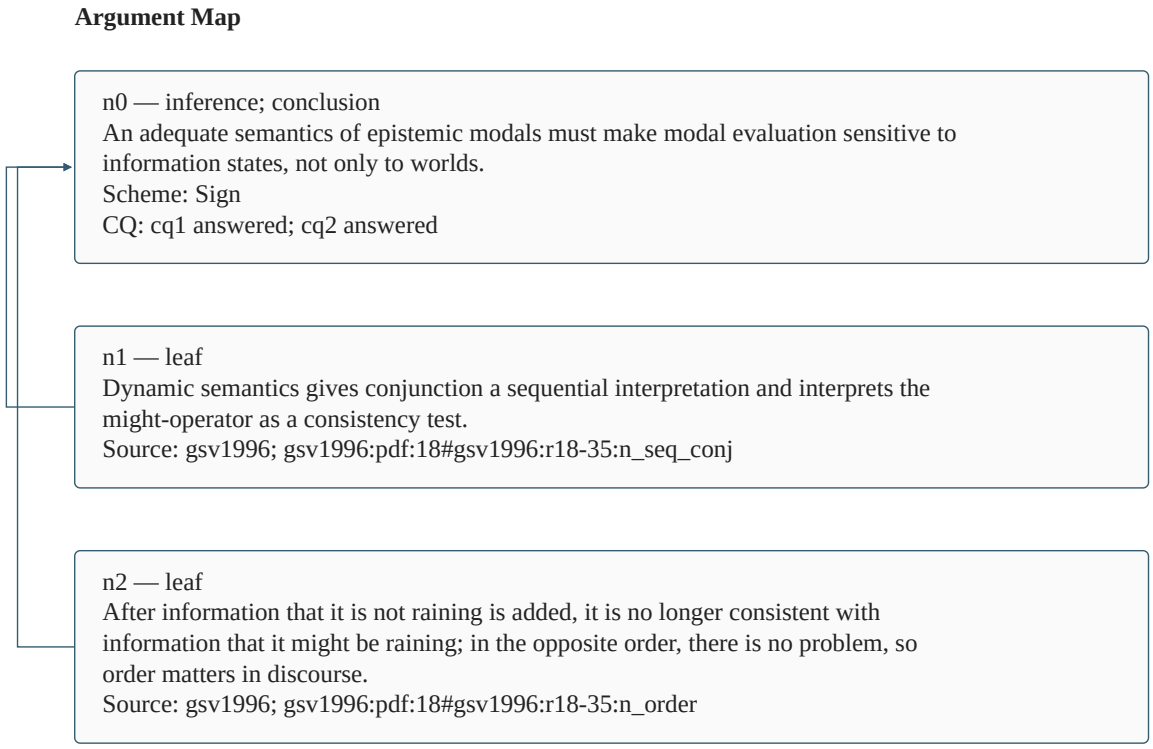


Figure 1. Route premises, inference schemes and conclusion. Arrows follow premise-to-conclusion links; CQ labels report recorded answers.

The connection begins with what the two semantic commitments specify: a sequential interpretation of conjunction and a consistency test for might. Might is treated as a consistency test, and the contrast at issue concerns whether the might-information remains consistent. Stated in this way, however, the commitments do not yet yield a general conclusion about every epistemic modal. They specify the treatment of conjunction and might that is used to understand the order contrast. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The contrast concerns the order in which information is added. In the first order, once the information that it is not raining has been added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining. In the opposite order, there is no problem. That is the whole of the contrast: after the not-

raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, whereas in the opposite order there is no problem. Order matters in discourse in precisely this sense. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The commitments make this contrast relevant to modal evaluation. Might tests consistency on an information state, and adding information in a different sequence changes whether the might-claim remains consistent. In one order, after the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information; in the opposite order, there is no problem. The commitments thereby connect sequential conjunction and consistency-testing might with the order effect, and in doing so they support information-state-sensitive evaluation. This is the route from the semantic commitments to the observed contrast. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The support for the conclusion follows that route. The commitments and the order contrast support information-state-sensitive modal evaluation rather than evaluation by worlds alone. The example thus supports the proposal that an adequate semantics must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. The conclusion is not that worlds play no role, but that information states must also figure in modal evaluation. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The inference therefore runs from sequential conjunction, consistency-testing might, and the order contrast to the demand that evaluation be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. The example's force is limited to that support. It supports the proposal's claim, but it does not by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves this way. Accordingly, the conclusion remains a requirement on an adequate semantics, supported by the described commitments and contrast, rather than an independently established result about all epistemic modals. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The route from the commitments to the contrast can be restated without extending either. The commitments are that conjunction receives a sequential interpretation and that might is treated as a consistency test. Nothing more is assumed about conjunction or might than these two commitments. The first-order result is that, once the information that it is not raining has been added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining. In the opposite order, there is no problem. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The contrast records whether the might-information is consistent in each of the two orders. After the not-raining information is added, it is no longer consistent with the might-information, while in the opposite order there is no problem. To say that order matters in discourse is to summarize this difference; the summary does not replace it with a claim about other sequences or other modal expressions. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The question whether the commitments support the conclusion receives an affirmative answer: the might-operator is treated as a consistency test on an information state, and adding information in a different sequence changes whether the might-claim remains consistent. This supports information-state-sensitive evaluation rather than evaluation by worlds alone. It is the connection between the

sequential interpretation and the contrast. The order effect is thus presented as relevant to modal evaluation through the way the consistency test applies to information added in sequence. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

Taken together, the commitments and the contrast support the requirement that modal evaluation be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. The conclusion is a demand on an adequate semantics, and the premises and their connection support that demand. It does not follow that worlds have no role, nor does the example by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves this way. The support remains conditional on the commitments and the described contrast, and the conclusion remains the specific adequacy requirement stated above. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The inference can be traced without enlarging either premise. The commitments are that conjunction is interpreted sequentially and that "might" tests consistency. The contrast supplies the case to which those commitments apply: after the information that it is not raining is added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining; in the opposite order, there is no problem. Together, the commitments and the contrast connect sequential information and consistency testing to the difference between these two orders. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

In sum, the commitments and the contrast support the demand that modal evaluation be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. That conclusion is supported by the commitments and the contrast; it is not presented as an independently established premise. Its scope remains the demand as stated: the example supports information-state sensitivity, but it does not by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves this way. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

5. Force of the Support

The central conclusion is that an adequate semantics of epistemic modals must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. Its stated support combines two commitments, one about conjunction and one about might, with a contrast between two orders of adding information. Dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and treats the might-operator as a consistency test. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

The contrast is specific. As stated, after the information that it is not raining is added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining; in the opposite order, there is no problem. The contrast is summed up in the claim that order matters in discourse. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] The support relies on this difference between the specified sequences and makes no claim about every possible order or every modal.

These two commitments explain why the difference bears on modal evaluation. Conjunction receives a sequential interpretation, and might is treated as a consistency test. Under these commitments, the question for a might-claim is whether it remains consistent with the information state against which it is assessed. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] When the sequence of information changes, the

consistency outcome in the stated example changes too: adding the not-raining information first leaves it no longer consistent with the might-information, whereas the reverse order presents no problem. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The example therefore supports information-state-sensitive evaluation: sequential addition affects the information state, and the might-test checks consistency with that state. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] This is the direction of support. Given the stated commitments and the order contrast, an adequate semantics must make modal evaluation sensitive to information states rather than relying on worlds alone. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

6. Objections and Replies

One objection is that a single order effect is too narrow to bear on epistemic modals in general. The reply is that the scope of the conclusion should be stated exactly. What it demands is sensitivity to information states, not only to worlds. The particular order effect does not by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves this way, and the conclusion does not claim that it does. The example supports the proposal's claim, but only in a limited role: it illustrates how consistency testing against sequentially updated information makes order relevant to modal evaluation. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

A second objection is that the argument simply assumes what it needs. In reply, the claim is explicitly conditional on the stated premises and on the connection drawn between them. If conjunction is interpreted sequentially, might tests consistency, and the described order contrast holds, then the contrast supports the demand that an adequate semantics make modal evaluation sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] The conclusion remains a requirement supported by these commitments and this example, not an independently established universal claim about epistemic modals.

This limit on the example's support determines how the conclusion should be stated. The order contrast supports information-state-sensitive modal evaluation: the might-claim is tested for consistency with information added in sequence. Yet the example does not, by itself, establish that every epistemic modal behaves this way. The conclusion is therefore the stated demand on an adequate semantics, not a universal generalization about all epistemic modals. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj]

This distinction keeps both sides of the support in view. On one side, the example's stated contrast is that after the information that it is not raining is added, it is no longer consistent with the information that it might be raining, while in the opposite order there is no problem. This is the specified sense in which order matters in discourse. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order] On the other side, the contrast is not stretched beyond its stated role. It shows how the specified sequences differ, but it does not establish that every epistemic modal behaves the same way. To the question whether the contrast is reliable evidence, the answer is thus yes: the example counts as evidence for information-state sensitivity, subject to the stated limit on what that evidence establishes. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

7. Limits

The same care applies to the semantic commitments. Dynamic semantics gives conjunction a sequential interpretation and interprets the might-operator as a consistency test. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] The commitments and the order contrast support the conclusion that modal evaluation must be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds. They do not turn the example into a claim about every modal, and the conclusion does not need that wider claim in order to state its demand. What the conclusion says is that an adequate semantics of epistemic modals must make information states matter to evaluation. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

The relevant inference therefore remains conditional on the stated commitments and contrast. If these are taken as support, they support information-state-sensitive evaluation, not evaluation by worlds alone. Nothing here claims that the premises have been independently established, and no conclusion is drawn about other sequences or modalities. The inference restates the direction of the support provided: it runs from the commitments and the specified order effect to the requirement on an adequate semantics. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

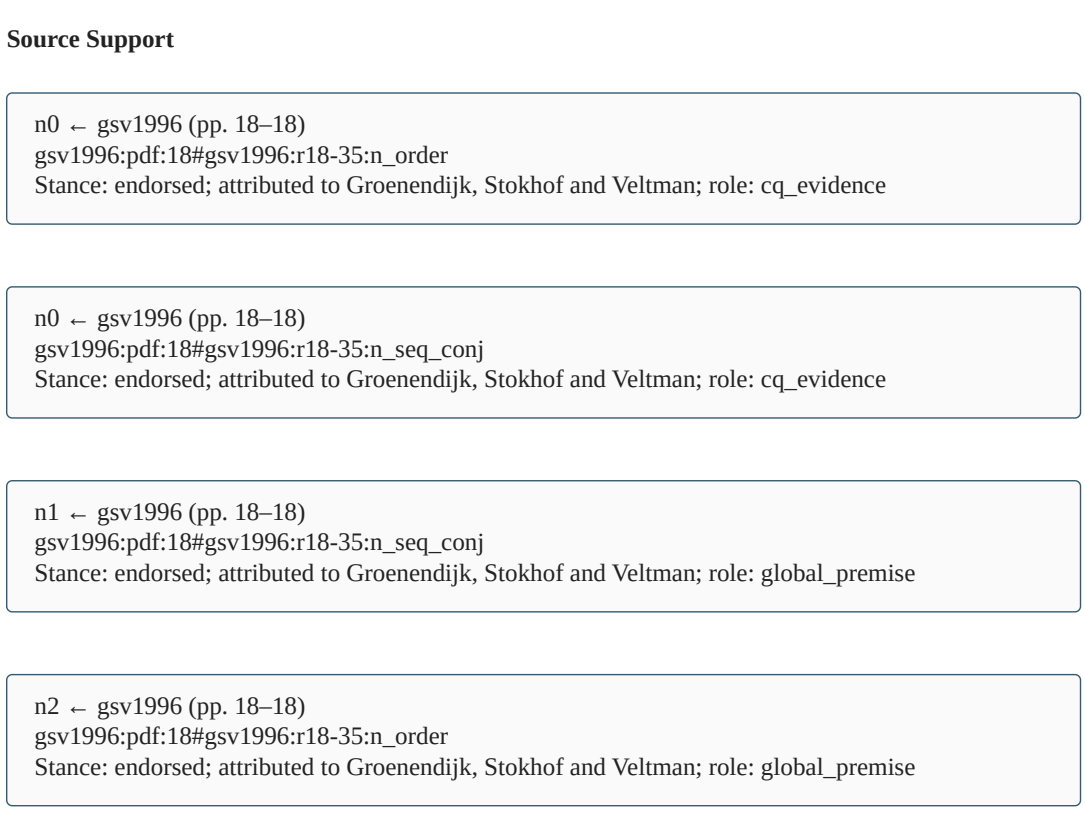


Figure 2. Frozen source support by route node, page citation, attribution and stance. Recorded support is not independent verification.

8. Conclusion

In sum, the conclusion requires modal evaluation to be sensitive to information states, not only to worlds, and the stated commitments and order contrast support information-state-sensitive modal evaluation. The limit is just as precise: this support does not by itself establish that every epistemic modal behaves the same way. Stating the requirement and its limit together keeps the conclusion's scope intact. The support licenses the demand for information-state-sensitive evaluation, but it does not license a universal claim about all epistemic modals. [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_seq_conj] [cite:gsv1996:r18-35:n_order]

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